

2026 • QUARTER 3 • INTER-EUROPEAN DIVISION



children's **mission**

**Yellow
Rescue Angel**

Contents

On the Cover: It was a very hot summer afternoon in Austria when Mother accidentally locked tiny Tamia in the car in the parking lot of a supermarket. Story, page 16.

BULGARIA

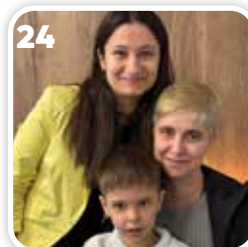
- 4 The Little Preacher | July 4
- 6 Big, Beautiful Bale | July 11
- 8 Rattling Wheel | July 18

SPAIN

- 10 Barbershop Chat | July 25
- 12 Making Others Happy | Aug. 1
- 14 School Surprise | Aug. 8

AUSTRIA

- 16 Yellow Rescue Angel | Aug. 15
- 18 Power of Prayer | Aug. 22



- 20 Cow Carpet Mix-Up | Aug. 29
- 22 Snowy Night's Prayer | Sept. 5

ROMANIA

- 24 A Place to Belong | Sept. 12
- 26 Tasty Eggs and New Clothes | Sept. 19
- 28 Thirteenth Sabbath:
Very Pleased Grandmother | Sept. 26
- 30 Future Thirteenth Sabbath Projects
- 31 Children's Activities
- 35 Leader's Resources
- 36 Map



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Dear Sabbath School Leader,

This quarter we feature the Inter-European Division, which oversees the Seventh-day Adventist Church's work in 20 countries and territories: Andorra, Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, the Czech Republic, France, Germany, Gibraltar, Italy, Liechtenstein, Luxembourg, Malta, Monaco, Portugal, Romania, San Marino, Slovakia, Spain, Switzerland, and Vatican City. The region is home to 343 million people, including 182,411 Adventists. That's a ratio of one Adventist for 1,880 people.

Funds raised by this quarter's Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, will support five projects in four countries: Belgium, Bulgaria, Italy, and Romania. You

can find more information about the projects in the sidebar on this page.

Special Features

To make your Sabbath School class come alive, we offer photos, videos, and other materials to accompany each mission story. More information is provided in the sidebar with each story. For photos of tourist sites and other scenes from the featured countries, try a free photo bank such as pixabay.com or unsplash.com. You could show the photos to the children on your computer or mobile device while you read the mission story, or you could print the photos to decorate your Sabbath School room or church bulletin board.

In addition, you can download Inter-European Division facts and activities at bit.ly/eud-2026 and a PDF version of *Children's Mission* at bit.ly/childrensmisson. A mission bank image, which children can color, can be found at bit.ly/bank-coloring-page. Follow us at facebook.com/missionquarterlies.

Be sure to download your free *Mission Spotlight* video featuring video reports from around the Inter-European Division and beyond. Download or stream from the Adventist Mission website at bit.ly/missionspotlight.

Please keep in mind that you do not need to read the story exactly as it is published. Feel free to adapt the content and language to the level that suits the age group of your Sabbath School class.

Thank you for encouraging children to be mission-minded!

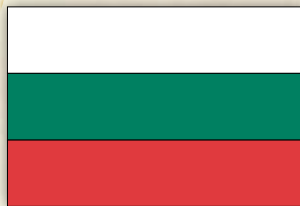
Opportunities

This quarter's Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, aims to reach and influence new generations for mission in the Inter-European Division through the following projects:

- Kindergarten, Sofia, Bulgaria
- Site for youth camp, church camp, and training center, Belgium
- Dormitory, Italian Adventist University Villa Aurora, Florence, Italy
- Schools in Macea and Peretu, Romania



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BULGARIA | July 4

Teo

The Little Preacher

Teo is a little boy who lives in Bulgaria. He had never heard about Jesus until his parents sent him to a Seventh-day Adventist kindergarten. Then, things began to change at home. Things changed a lot.

Teo, who was two and a half years old, loved hearing Bible stories at the kindergarten. He loved learning Christian songs there as well. So, when he went home, he told Father and Mother what he had heard and learned. His parents were very kind and gentle, but they knew nothing about God.

Every evening, Teo called his parents for family worship. He told them the Bible stories he had heard that day and sang the Christian songs he had sung. Father and Mother were so surprised! They nicknamed the boy “The Preacher” because he wouldn’t stop talking about Jesus.

Then, Teo asked his parents to play Christian music in the car. He insisted on listening to Christian songs—and only Christian songs.

Father and Mother didn’t know where to find Christian songs, so they asked other

parents at the kindergarten for help. Those parents showed them an internet site where they could download Christian songs for free. The other parents also helped them join an online group of Christian parents.

A year passed. Two years passed. And Teo, the little preacher, kept going to the kindergarten during the day and teaching his parents about God at home in the evening.

One day, Teo was distressed and started crying at home.

Father was impatient and said, “It isn’t the end of the world. Stop crying.” Then Father asked, “Teo, what are you going to do when the end of the world comes?”

Immediately, Teo replied, “I’ll pray, and I’ll trust God, of course.”

Father was very surprised. Mother also was very surprised when Father told her later. She told Teo’s kindergarten teacher, who also was surprised. No one at the kindergarten had ever talked about the end of the world. Of course, the kindergarten teachers believed that the world would end and that Jesus would come one day soon.

Teo stayed at the kindergarten until he



was six years old. Then he left to start first grade in school.

But “The Preacher” and his parents still have worship at home. Father and Mother found a Bible and read it during family worship. They listen to Adventist sermons online and read Adventist books. The kindergarten teachers keep in touch with them and pray that they will give their hearts to God. 🌐

Teo’s story is one of many about children who learned about God at the kindergarten in Bulgaria and then shared what they learned with their parents at home. Teo is a little preacher who taught his family about God.

You can help the kindergarten—called Colorful Hope (Tzventna Nadezhda)—teach more children about the God of heaven by giving this quarter to the Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering. Part of the offering will help the kindergarten move from rented facilities into its own building in Sofia, Bulgaria. Thank you for your generous offering.

Story Tips

- Show Bulgaria on a map. Then, show the capital, Sofia, where the Colorful Hope (Tzventna Nadezhda) kindergarten is located.
- Pronounce Teo as TEE-o.
- Know that the photo is a stock image of a Bulgarian boy similar to Teo.
- Know that Teo enjoyed morning worship—called “spiritual breakfast” by the teachers—at the kindergarten and then wanted to have evening worship at home. Watch a YouTube video in which kindergarten teacher Maria talks about the importance of spiritual breakfast at: bit.ly/Maria-C-EUD.
- Know that Maria, the kindergarten’s founder, sees all her kindergarten children as little missionaries. She says, “Because all the children learn Bible stories and how to pray, they are all missionaries at home. All the parents tell us—with no exceptions—that they now pray before meals because their children insist on it.” Maria adds, “It’s very important the children spend so much time with us in an atmosphere saturated with the Spirit of God. We believe that the seeds we are planting now will yield a rich harvest in the children’s adult lives.”



MISSION RECORD

In the early 1890s, a group of German Adventists, who had emigrated from the German settlements in Russia and had settled in Romania, near the Bulgarian border, spread their beliefs among their Romanian and Bulgarian neighbors.

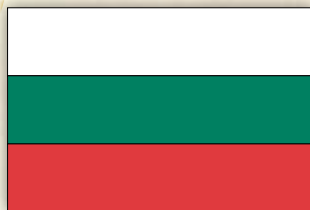
In 1899, Ellen G. White’s *Steps to Christ* was the first Adventist book translated into Bulgarian and published in Bulgaria.

In 1911, C. Motzer, a minister from Germany, organized the Bulgarian Mission. By 1912, a church of eight members had been organized in Sofia.

The Seventh-day Adventist Church was not officially recognized by the Bulgarian government until 1990.



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BULGARIA | July 11

Teacher Maria

Big, Beautiful Bale

Christmas was just around the corner, and a Seventh-day Adventist kindergarten in Bulgaria wanted to celebrate.

The teachers planned to transform the kindergarten into the little town of Bethlehem, where Jesus was born. Then, they could invite all the kindergarten children—along with their mothers and fathers, grandfathers and grandmothers, uncles and aunts, and cousins—to come and learn about the birth of Jesus. Many of the children came from families who didn't know Jesus.

The teachers talked excitedly about turning the kindergarten into Bethlehem. They could place a city gate in one area and build a carpenter's workshop nearby—like the one where Jesus' father, Joseph, worked with wood. A store could stand in a corner, and next to it could be a stable with a manger holding Baby Jesus. An entire room could become a Bethlehem field where shepherds watched their sheep and heard the angels proclaim Jesus' birth.

But there was a problem. To create a field, the kindergarten needed hay—lots of hay.

But the kindergarten was in the middle of Sofia, the capital city of Bulgaria. Hay grows in the countryside, and there didn't seem to be any hay in the city.

Teacher Maria asked some kind friends to try to find a big bale of hay. They were happy to help and looked and looked for some hay. Eventually, they learned that there were horse stables just outside the city. Everyone knows horses eat hay, so they called the stables to ask whether they could buy some. But the owners refused. They said that they had only enough hay for their horses and couldn't possibly spare any for the kindergarten.

Teacher Maria and the other teachers felt sad. It seemed there would be no hay for their Bethlehem field.

Then, something amazing happened—just one day before the little town of Bethlehem was set to open. Teacher Maria received a photo on her phone. It showed a big, beautiful bale of hay sitting on the leather backseat of a car. The message that came with it read, "You won't believe what happened."

Sure enough, when Teacher Maria learned



what had happened, she could not believe it.

Two friends had been walking down a sidewalk in the city center when they saw a bale of hay. It was a clean bale sitting on the sidewalk. At first, they walked right past it. But then one said, “Do you realize what we just saw?”

The two looked at each other and went back. Surely someone had left it there to feed a horse. But no horse was in sight.

Then the friends saw the big display window of a nearby store and realized what had happened. The hay had been part of the window decorations, but someone had changed the display and thrown out the hay.

The hay traveled grandly on the leather backseat of the car to the kindergarten. Then, the teachers happily spread it around the room. Bethlehem now had a real field of hay.

The next day, when the little town of Bethlehem opened, two people dressed as angels stood in the hayfield and told the children—along with their mothers and fathers, grandfathers and grandmothers, uncles and aunts, and cousins—how a choir of angels announced Jesus’ birth.

The hay stayed in the kindergarten room for many months. Children sat on it during morning worship and knelt on it when they prayed.

Later, the teachers used some of the hay in the kindergarten’s garden to help vegetables grow. Some of the hay lasted until the next Christmas, when it was divided between three churches that also wanted to share the Christmas story.

“The hay had a long and faithful service,” said Teacher Maria. “We are amazed that

Story Tips

- Show Bulgaria on a map, including Sofia, where the Colorful Hope (Tzventna Nadezhda) kindergarten is located.
- Encourage the children to take all their requests, whether big or small, to God in prayer. Remind them that if God can answer a prayer for hay in Bulgaria, He can answer any request, anywhere, according to His will.
- Show the children a YouTube video of Teacher Maria, who appears in this week’s story, as she encourages them to enjoy a “spiritual breakfast” with Jesus every morning: bit.ly/Maria-C-EUD

God cares about even the smallest details. We know He always provides the big things—but He also takes care of even the smallest things.”

The teachers have shared the hay story with many parents, and they are happy to know that they can turn to God with even the smallest request. 🌍

Part of this quarter’s offering will allow the Colorful Hope (Tzventna Nadezhda) kindergarten move out of a rented facility into a building of its own in Sofia. More than half of the children who attend come from families who are not members of the Seventh-day Adventist Church—and some do not even believe in God. Thank you for your generous support of this life-changing project in Bulgaria.



AMAZING COUNTRY

Bulgaria is the largest producer in the world of lavender and rose oils, which are used for French perfumes.



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BULGARIA | July 18

Rattling Wheel

Mr. Borislav

Three Seventh-day Adventists piled into the car and headed for Blagoevgrad, a city in southwestern Bulgaria.

It was the time of communism, and the laws were strict. The authorities wouldn't allow an Adventist pastor to visit the city, where a group of five Roma people wanted to hear the Word of God. So, Mr. Borislav, a 35-year-old Roma Adventist, invited two friends to join him on the 45-mile (70-kilometer) trip from Kyustendil.

About halfway there, the car suddenly made a loud noise and shook violently. Mr. Borislav stopped the vehicle, and he and the passengers got out to find the source of the problem. They saw that something had broken near the front wheel on the driver's side.

"We can't continue," he said. "We need to get the car repaired here." It was Mr. Borislav's car, and he wasn't sure he wanted to continue.

But one of his friends had strong faith. "Let's go," the man said. "God will be with us."

Mr. Borislav and his skeptical friend were reluctant, but the man of faith kept encouraging them. Mr. Borislav finally started the engine.

Pop, pop, pop! The car made a loud noise and shook again.

Mr. Borislav slowed down.

Pop, pop, pop! The rattling grew louder.

"Let's turn on some music so we can't hear that noise," the skeptical man suggested.

"No, let's sing so we can't hear it," the man of faith said.

The men decided to sing a hymn.

As they sang, something amazing happened. The loud *pop, pop, pop* stopped. The violent shaking ended. The car ran quietly and smoothly. The men sang all the way to their destination.

There, people were waiting eagerly to learn from the Bible. Mr. Borislav realized the trip had been important and that Satan had tried to stop them.

The men didn't leave the little group until midnight. By then, it was too late to deal with the car. So, the faithful friend suggested they drive home while singing another hymn.

The car ran perfectly while they sang. But, after a while, the men grew weary of singing. They rode in silence for a minute.

Then came the dreaded *pop, pop, pop!*



The car rattled and shook again. But as soon as the three men began singing, the noise and shaking stopped. So, they sang all the way home!

Mr. Borislav only realized the full extent of the miracle when he took the car to be repaired. The mechanic looked at it in disbelief.

“There’s no way this car could have driven there and back,” he told Mr. Borislav. “After the wheel bearing broke, the front wheel should have jammed within a minute or two.”

The meeting between Mr. Borislav and his friends and the small group of Roma people led to the establishment of a Seventh-day Adventist church in Blagoevgrad. It continues to meet every Sabbath and is growing larger all the time. Mr. Borislav later became a pastor.

Even after he retired, he never forgot the rattling wheel. It reminded him of James 4:7, which says, “Therefore submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you” (NKJV).

Story Tips

- Find Blagoevgrad, Bulgaria, on a map. Show the route from Kyustendil to Blagoevgrad.
- Note that the Roma people in Bulgaria have their own culture, traditions, and language. They are one of the largest ethnic groups in the country.
- Watch Mr. Borislav on YouTube: bit.ly/Borislav-Mitov.

“The lesson that I learned is that we should resist the devil so he will flee from us,” he said. 🌍

Part of the first quarter 2020 Thirteenth Sabbath Offering helped construct a church building for the Sophia West Seventh-day Adventist Church in Sofia, Bulgaria. Thank you for your generous support of the Thirteenth Sabbath Offering!



AMAZING COUNTRY

Bulgarian folk music has a distinctive sound and uses traditional instruments, such as the gadulka, gaida, kaval, and tupan. The gaida is a bagpipe and is Bulgaria’s national instrument.



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SPAIN | July 25

Mauricio

Barbershop Chat

Mauricio is seven years old and loves to talk about Jesus to anyone who will listen in Spain.

The other day, Mother took Mauricio to the barber for a haircut. The barber directed the boy to a tall barber's chair beside a white-brick wall. Once Mauricio had climbed up and sat down, the barber wrapped a long black-and-white cloth around his neck to keep hair off his clothes. Mauricio gazed into the mirror in front of him as the barber began snipping with his scissors.

Snip. Snip. Snip.

Clip. Clip. Clip.

Mauricio didn't sit silently for long. As clumps of brown hair fluttered to the floor, he started a conversation with the barber, a young man with short black hair. It was a hot Friday afternoon, and the barber wore shorts and a black T-shirt.

Mauricio asked about the barber's plans for the next day, which happened to be a Saturday.

"I'm going to be open tomorrow," the barber said.

Mauricio didn't think that that was right.

"You shouldn't do that," he said. "You need

to go to church instead of opening the barbershop."

The barber was surprised, but he replied very politely.

"Why?" he said. "Why should I go to church?"

"Because there you will learn about Jesus," Mauricio said. "You have to come to church every Sabbath and bring your Bible."

"But I don't have a Bible," the barber said. "Can I still go?"

"Yes, you may come," the boy said. "You are allowed to come without a Bible."

But he thought the barber really should own a Bible.

"You should read your Bible every day, and you need to pray," he said.

"Do you read your Bible?" the barber asked.

"Of course!" the boy said.

Snip. Clip. Snip. Clip.

Drrrrrrrrrr.

The barber ran an electric razor over the boy's neck.

Mauricio noticed the music playing in the barber's shop. He had been taught that some music was fine for weekdays but not for the Sabbath.



“On Sabbath, you are not supposed to listen to the music you’re playing here,” he said. “On Sabbath, you should listen to music about God.”

Drrrrrrrrrr.

The barber continued with the electric razor.

Mauricio invited the barber to come to church. He promised that the church was a happy place.

“You should come because I’m happy at church,” he said.

The barber finished the haircut and removed the long black-and-white cloth from around Mauricio’s neck. Then, he showed Mauricio his new haircut in the mirror and said with a big smile, “OK, we’ll see you at church.”

The barber didn’t attend church the next day, but Mauricio wasn’t worried. He planned to invite him again. The barber didn’t know the church’s address, and Mauricio intended to give it to him at his next haircut.

“Yes, I’ll invite him again,” he said enthusiastically. “I also want to give him my little sister’s Bible, or maybe I’ll give him my small Bible. But I can’t give him my big Bible. I love it too much, and what would I have to read if I gave it away?” 🌐

Mauricio attends school on a campus that received part of a previous Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering. The

Story Tips

- Show Spain on a map. Then show Sagunto, a town near Valencia on the eastern coast. Sagunto Adventist College received part of the offering in first quarter 2020 to expand its theology department.
- Pronounce Mauricio as MAU-ree-see-o.
- Watch a YouTube video of Mauricio getting the haircut in this story at: bit.ly/Mauricio-EUD.
- Know that the barber isn’t the only person whom Mauricio has invited to church. He regularly invites a 52-year-old neighbor, a woman who owns a car dealership, and tells her that it would be better for her to go to church than to sell cars on the Sabbath.
- Know that Mauricio loves to read the Bible. He reads the Bible with his family during morning and evening worship and then on his own in bed. He owns several children’s picture Bibles in the Spanish and Portuguese languages. Encourage the children in Sabbath School to be like Mauricio and read their Bibles faithfully.

campus includes a Seventh-day Adventist elementary school, high school, and college in Sagunto, Spain. This quarter’s offering will help more people know about Jesus in Spain and other countries in the Inter-European Division. Thank you for planning a generous offering.



MISSION RECORD

During the summer of 1903, brothers Frank and Walter Bond arrived from California and settled in Catalonia, and despite not knowing the local language (the people spoke Catalan), they went to work, using their meager knowledge of Spanish. They opened a school, and in June 1904, three people were baptized.



SPAIN | August 1

Anna, Mother, and Pere

Making Others Happy

Pere and Anna like making surprises in Spain.

In their yard, they have a big lemon tree that produces lots of bright yellow lemons. Pere and Anna like to pick the fruit and put it in small bags. Then, they give the bags as surprise gifts to neighbors.

The neighbors are always happy and grateful for the gifts. Sometimes, they give Pere and Anna small treats in return. Receiving gifts makes the children feel happy, too.

Pere and Anna also enjoy drawing. Whenever someone has a birthday, they like to draw pictures and give them as gifts. The people who receive the drawings are always delighted.

Father and Mother encourage Pere and Anna to find ways to make other people happy. They tell them this is how they can share Jesus' love. So, Pere and Anna have made it a kind of game to try to find ways to brighten someone's day.

One Sunday morning, Pere and Anna learned that a 13-year-old friend named Leo had been left at home without his mother.

She was a doctor and had gone on a mission trip, leaving Leo and his father to cook all their own meals for a whole week.

Pere and Anna thought it must be hard for a boy and a man to cook for seven days. They wanted to help, so they told Mother, "Let's cook some food!"

Soon, Pere and Anna were busy in the kitchen, preparing homemade bread and *tortilla de patata*, a traditional Spanish omelet made with potatoes.

The children cracked eggs while Mother fried potatoes in a pan until they were soft. Then she poured the potatoes into a bowl with the eggs, mixed everything together, and poured the mixture into the pan again to cook.

Next, the children worked on the bread. They measured flour, water, yeast, and other ingredients, poured them into a bread machine, pressed a button—and waited. Soon, a big loaf of bread popped out.

The children helped Mother make other food as well. When they finished, they had enough to feed Leo and his father three meals. They wrapped up all the food and



added a note that said, “We want to help you out, and we love you.”

Pere, Anna, and Mother delivered the food to Leo’s house just in time for lunch at 2 o’clock in the afternoon. (People in Spain usually eat lunch at 2 o’clock.)

The children held out the surprise bag of food, and Mother said, “We thought you might be very busy and not have time to cook, so we brought you some food.”

A big smile spread across Leo’s father’s face. This was a wonderful surprise!

“Thank you so very much!” he exclaimed.

Later, Mother received an unexpected message on her phone. It was from Leo’s father. He sent a photo of him and Leo enjoying a meal prepared by Pere and Anna.

Then Father also received a message on his phone—a second photo of the special meal.

Pere and Anna continued delivering food for the rest of the week. Every day, Mother and Father received new photos of a happy father and son.

Pere liked seeing the photos because he knew he was helping his friend and his friend’s father.

Anna was happy because Leo and his father were happy.

It felt wonderful to share Jesus’ love by making people happy! 🌍

Story Tips

- Show Spain on a map. Then, show Sagunto, a town near Valencia on the eastern coast. Sagunto Adventist College received part of the offering in the first quarter of 2020 to expand its theology department.
- Know that Leo is not the boy’s real name.
- Watch a YouTube video of Pere, Anna, and their mother, Sara, at: bit.ly/Anna-EUD.
- Encourage the Sabbath School children to share Jesus’ love by making people happy. Ask them to brainstorm about ways that they can make others happy. Possible answers from the lives of Pere and Anna include picking fruit and giving it to neighbors, drawing pictures as gifts on birthdays, and preparing surprise meals.

Pere and Anna attend school on a campus that received part of a previous Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering. The campus includes a Seventh-day Adventist elementary school, high school, and college in Sagunto, Spain. This quarter’s offering will help more people learn about Jesus in Spain and other countries in the Inter-European Division. Thank you for planning a generous offering.



AMAZING COUNTRY

Wildlife in Doñana National Park includes the European badger (pictured), the Egyptian mongoose, the Spanish imperial eagle, and the Iberian lynx.



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SPAIN | August 8

School Surprise

Nacho

School surprised Nacho in Spain. When he came home from his first day of school in Spain, he ran to Mother and exclaimed, “We don’t have Bible class. We don’t pray. We don’t learn or memorize Bible verses. My teacher doesn’t even know about God.”

Nacho’s public school in Spain was nothing like the Seventh-day Adventist school he had attended the previous year back home in Argentina.

Nacho had moved with his parents to Spain because of his father’s studies. His parents chose a university near a Seventh-day Adventist school, hoping that Nacho could attend. But when they arrived, they learned that the school was full.

Many parents wanted their children to attend the Adventist school, so there was a waiting list of children hoping to study there. Nacho was put on the list, and Mother suggested they pray.

“We need to pray because only God can get you into the school,” she said. “If you get in, it will be a miracle.”

Nacho very much wanted to attend

a school with Bible class, prayers, Bible memory verses, and teachers who knew about God. That night, during family worship, he prayed: “Dear Jesus, please open a spot for me. Only You can do this. I trust You. In Jesus’ name, Amen.”

The next morning, before school, he prayed again: “Bless us today and protect us with Your angels at school. But also, please open a spot for me!”

Then he went to public school with a great attitude and a big smile on his face.

At mealtime, Nacho liked to say short prayers because he was hungry and eager to eat. But now, he made his prayers a little longer: “Dear Jesus, bless this food, and please open up a spot for me.”

A month passed—then two, then three, then four. Nacho prayed every night, every morning, and at every meal. His parents also prayed for him to be able to go to the Adventist school. Sometimes, though, they forgot. But Nacho always remembered and gently reminded them to keep praying.

After five months of prayer, Mother began to have doubts. She wondered what to tell Nacho if he prayed for a whole year and still didn’t get into the Adventist school.

“Maybe God wants you to stay in public



school so you can tell your friends there about Jesus,” she said. “Let’s pray that His will be done.”

Many of Nacho’s friends at the public school didn’t know God. They weren’t Christians.

So, Nacho told them about Jesus—and he kept praying.

Then one day, Mother heard that several children at the Adventist school were moving away. But it still seemed unlikely Nacho would be able to enroll. Four students in his grade would need to leave for a space to open for him.

After eight months of prayers, someone called Mother from the Adventist school and told her that four children had left—and there was now a place for Nacho. He could start at the beginning of the new school year.

Mother couldn’t wait to tell Nacho! She bought him a school uniform and tucked it into a box. When she got home, she gave it to him and said, “Here’s a package for you. It just arrived.”

Nacho had no idea what was inside. When he opened it, his eyes grew wide. It was a school uniform!

“God has answered your prayers!” Mother exclaimed.

A bright smile filled Nacho’s face. He was so happy! Immediately, he put on the uniform and jumped around the room.

Today, Nacho loves studying at the Adventist school. He loves Bible class, praying, learning and memorizing Bible verses—and he loves that his teachers love God.

“God answers prayers and is faithful,” he says. “Before, I thought that God sometimes

Story Tips

- Show Spain on a map. Then, point out Sagunto, a town near Valencia on the eastern coast. Sagunto Adventist College received part of the offering in the first quarter of 2020 to expand its theology department.
- Watch a YouTube video of Nacho at: bit.ly/Nacho-EUD.
- Emphasize that Nacho taught his mother a lesson about faithfully waiting. As he prayed and waited, he never complained about going to public school. Every morning, he went to class with a big smile and a positive attitude. His mother says, “He taught me a lesson to be OK with waiting. He had to wait eight months.” Tell the children that it is good to wait patiently for the Lord, and remind them that when they pray, things happen.

answers prayers. But after that experience, I believe that God always answers prayers.” 🌍

Nacho attends school on a campus that received part of a previous Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering. The campus includes a Seventh-day Adventist elementary school, high school, and college in Sagunto, Spain. This quarter’s offering will help more people learn about Jesus in Spain and other countries in the Inter-European Division. Thank you for planning a generous offering!



AMAZING COUNTRY

Spain is the world’s largest producer of olive oil, nearly 40% of the total global production.

BigStockPhoto.com





AUSTRIA | August 15

Tamia

Yellow Rescue Angel

It was a very hot summer afternoon in Austria when Mother accidentally locked tiny Tamia in the car in the parking lot of a supermarket.

Mother hadn't gone to the supermarket planning to lock her 18-month-old daughter in the car. She had gone with an important mission: to fill the refrigerator with food. Her shopping list included bread, milk, and many delicious vegetables and fruits.

After shopping, Tamia sat in the cart beside the car as Mother packed the car trunk with the groceries. Then, Mother returned the cart to the supermarket, picked up Tamia, and carried her to the car. Opening the rear door, she placed Tamia in her child seat. She needed both hands to fasten Tamia's seatbelt, so she threw the car keys into the front seat.

When she did, it's possible she accidentally pressed the car-lock button on the keys. Or perhaps the button was pushed when the keys landed. Nobody knows. But when Mother closed the rear door and tried to open the front one, she discovered all the car doors were locked. She couldn't open the

front door. She couldn't open the rear door. Even the trunk was locked.

Then, Mother remembered her purse with her cell phone and money was in the trunk. Everything was locked in the car: her phone, her money, and, most importantly, her little Tamia.

Mother ran back inside the supermarket. She knew only one phone number by heart: Tamia's grandmother's. She asked a supermarket worker whether she could borrow her phone.

The worker handed over her cell phone, and Mother called Grandmother. Frantically, she explained the situation and asked her to call Father. Maybe he was nearby and could come help. But Grandmother soon learned that Father was very far away.

Still, Father wanted to help, so he called a roadside assistance service. But the roadside service said it would take more than an hour for anyone to arrive.

Mother was devastated. It was a very hot summer afternoon, and tiny Tamia was turning red inside the car. Tamia didn't understand why it was so hot and why



Mother wasn't in the car with her. She was bawling loudly.

Mother prayed.

"Dear God," she said. "Nobody is here to help me. Only You can help. I really need Your help now."

Opening her eyes, she saw a yellow car pulling into the parking lot. Roadside assistance cars are often yellow. Some people even call the drivers "yellow angels" because of their yellow cars.

Mother was so surprised. Could it be a yellow angel? She looked more closely. It was! It was a car belonging to the roadside service.

Mother ran to the yellow car, crying, "I need urgent help! My little girl is locked in the car!"

A man jumped out of the yellow car. He grabbed some equipment from his trunk and rushed over. In just a few moments, he had unlocked the car and freed Tamia.

Tamia was so happy to see Mother. Mother was so happy to see Tamia.

Then the man told Mother, "I just stopped here to grab a sandwich. I was on my way to help someone else."

The man thought that the only reason he

Story Tips

- Show Austria on a map. Then point to Braunau, a town near the German border in the north, where Bogenhofen is located.
- Watch a YouTube video of Tamia, who is now 12, at: bit.ly/Tamia-EUD.

had stopped at the supermarket was to eat a sandwich. But Mother knew better. She knew that God had sent him there to rescue Tamia.

Mother smiled at the man.

"You really are a yellow angel today," she said. 🌍

Thank you for your Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, that will help children in Europe learn about the God who answers prayer. Mother now teaches children about the importance of prayer at Bogenhofen, a Seventh-day Adventist school that received part of a previous offering. Thank you for planning a generous offering this quarter.



MISSION RECORD

In 1895, missionary L. R. Conradi conducted the first Adventist baptismal service in Austria-Hungary at Klausenburg (now in Romania).

The first Adventist church was established in Ratzersdorf, Austria, in 1903, by L. Mathe, a German-American pastor.

Mathe's life was threatened on several occasions by local Christians, so he moved to nearby Vienna, where he performed the first Adventist baptism in Austria on July 1, 1903.

In 1909, the first native Austrian Adventist minister, Franz Gruber, was ordained in Vienna. The church worked hard to train local missionary workers because foreign pastors were in constant danger of being deported for "disturbing the peace."



AUSTRIA | August 22

Nandor

Power of Prayer

Nandor went to public school in Austria, and he didn't like it at all. The other boys used bad language, and after school, they often did unkind things. Some of them even scared him—they were just plain mean.

Nandor really wished he could go to a different school.

Then, at church, he heard about a Seventh-day Adventist school at Bogenhofen.

"We have a school here," people said. "Nandor could study here."

Nandor longed to attend the Adventist school, but it felt like an impossible dream. He lived in a town quite far from Bogenhofen. The drive took 50 minutes each way, and it would be difficult for his parents to take him back and forth every day.

But Nandor really wanted to go. So, he began to pray—earnestly and every day.

"Dear God, can I please go to the Adventist school?" he pleaded.

He prayed every day for six months.

Then, one day, Father and Mother decided they should try to move. If they could find a house closer to the school, Nandor could

attend. But it wasn't easy to find such a house. Many people wanted to live near the school. So, Nandor added another request to his prayers.

"Dear God, please help us find a house," he prayed.

Then, something amazing happened. A man called Nandor's mother to tell her about a house for sale near the school.

Nandor's mother had shared her phone number at church, hoping someone would call if they heard of a house for sale.

This man had received her number and remembered her when he saw the house.

"I have found a house," he said. "Perhaps it's for you."

Mother was thrilled and drove out to see the house right away. An elderly woman lived there, and she came out to greet her.

"I heard that you're selling your house," Mother said.

"Oh, yes, come in," the old woman replied.

Soon, that house became Nandor's new home.

Many people at church were surprised to learn that Nandor and his family had moved



close to the school.

“We don’t understand how you got this house,” they said. “So many people want to move here, and you’re not even from the area.”

But Nandor knew how it had happened. He had prayed, and God had answered.

He began attending the Adventist school, and he quickly made new friends. The new school was completely different from his old one. The children were kind and polite, and he looked forward to going every day. Each day, he prayed, “Thank You, God!”

Nandor has now attended the Adventist school for two years—and he couldn’t be happier.

“I’m very thankful,” he said. “I prayed and got a house and a school!” 🌍

Thank you for your Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, which will

Story Tips

- Show Austria on a map, then locate Braunau, a town near the German border in the north, where Bogenhofen is located.
- Watch a YouTube video of Nandor at: bit.ly/Nandor-EUD.
- Encourage the Sabbath School children to pray and never give up.

help more children learn about the God who answers prayer. Nandor studies at Bogenhofen, a Seventh-day Adventist school in Austria that received part of a previous offering. This quarter’s offering will help teach more children about God in the Inter-European Division, which includes Austria. Thank you for planning a generous offering!



AMAZING COUNTRY

Hallstatt in Austria is known for its salt mines, and there are traces of mining as far back as 2000 B.C.

Much of Austria is located in the Alps, a mountain range stretching 750 miles (1,200 km) across the European countries of Austria, France, Germany, Italy, Liechtenstein, Monaco, Slovenia, and Switzerland.



BigStockPhoto.com



AUSTRIA | August 29

Lilli

Cow Carpet Mix-Up

Little 5-year-old Lilli went to a big store in Austria. She didn't go alone—no, no. She went with Mother. But then she got lost.

Here's what happened.

Lilli was wearing her favorite pink shirt as she and Mother walked up and down the aisles of the big store. They looked at this, and they looked at that.

Suddenly, Lilli said, "I want to stay here and look at this."

The "this" happened to be a carpet that was on sale. It was the most unusual carpet Lilli had ever seen. It had brown, white, and black spots and kind of looked like a cow. Lilli wanted to stop and touch the cow carpet.

Mother didn't mind at all.

"Sure," she said. "I'm here standing right beside you."

Lilli ran her fingers over the cow carpet. She imagined she was petting a pretty brown, white, and black cow. She could almost hear it say, "Moo, Lilli, moo."

Then she looked up. Where was Mother? She couldn't see her anywhere. She turned around—no Mother. Fear gripped her heart,

and tears spilled out of her eyes.

She prayed.

"Dear Jesus, help me find Mother," she said.

At that moment, a woman came over and asked kindly, "What's wrong? Can I help you?"

"Yes," Lilli said. "I'm looking for my mother."

"Where did you last see her?" the woman asked. "Show me the place."

Lilli, sobbing, led the woman to the cow carpet with the brown, white, and black spots. Standing next to the carpet was a very familiar-looking woman. Lilli looked at the woman more closely.

Could it be? Yes, yes, it was! It was Mother!

"Mother!" she exclaimed.

With cheeks wet with tears, she grabbed Mother in a big hug. Her tears were no longer from sadness or fear. Lilli was so happy that she was shedding tears of joy.

Mother also was crying. While Lilli had been touching the carpet, Mother had been looking at something else nearby. But when she turned around and couldn't see Lilli, she became afraid. She told everyone in the store, "My daughter has disappeared. Her



name is Lilli, and she's wearing a pink shirt." Very quickly, many people were searching for her.

No one understood what had happened. Mother didn't think she had left Lilli at the cow carpet. Lilli didn't think she had left Mother. But, somehow, Lilli had gotten lost.

In any case, it didn't matter. Daughter and Mother were reunited. It was the happiest of reunions! Everyone in the store was happy. Mother was happy. And Lilli was very happy—because Jesus had answered her prayer.

Lilli loves Jesus very much and talks to Him all the time, even when she isn't lost. She thanks Him for everything and tells Him everything. She even dreams about Him at night.

"I like talking to Jesus and dreaming of Him," she said. 🌍

Thank you for your Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, that will help more

Story Tips

- Show Austria on a map. Then show Braunau, a town near the German border in the north, where Bogenhofen is located.
- Watch a YouTube video of Lilli at: bit.ly/Lilli-EUD.
- Note that Lilli has been lost more than once. One Sabbath, she lost sight of Mother at church and immediately closed her eyes and prayed. When she opened her eyes, Mother stood right before her.

children know about Jesus. Lilli is now nine years old and studies at Bogenhofen, a Seventh-day Adventist school in Austria that received part of a previous offering. This quarter's offering will help teach more children about Jesus in the Inter-European Division, which includes Austria. Thank you for planning a generous offering.



AMAZING COUNTRY

Popular Austrian foods include Sachertorte (a rich chocolate cake) and Apfelstrudel (a flaky pastry filled with apples).



BigStockPhoto.com



AUSTRIA | September 5

Amelie

Snowy Night's Prayer

Winter had arrived in Austria, and white snowflakes fell thick and fast outside the window.

Amelie was very happy—it was the first snow of winter! She jumped up and down with joy. Her sister, Tamia, joined her, bouncing with excitement. Mother was excited too, and she jumped up and down with the two girls.

“We just have to go outside!” Amelie exclaimed.

It didn’t matter that it was already dark. It didn’t matter that the girls were already dressed in their pajamas for bed. Amelie wanted to go outside and jump up and down in the snow. Mother and Tamia agreed—it was a marvelous idea!

Everyone quickly changed into their ski pants and warm winter coats. Mother strapped lights to the girls’ heads, then put one on her own. Headlamps were better than flashlights. Now, they could see in the dark, and their hands would be free as they played in the snow.

The two girls and Mother bounded out of

the house. After Mother locked the door, the three of them began to jump in the snow. Up and down, up and down, they jumped. It was so much fun leaping through the white fluff!

Then Mother pulled out the sled. It was a beautiful dark-red sled that could fly down hills very fast. The girls and Mother climbed a hill by the house. Then, the girls sat on the sled, and Mother gave them a push.

Whee! With a scream of delight, the girls flew down the hill. But they didn’t want to wait for the sled to reach the bottom. That would be boring. So, they purposely fell off as the sled zoomed downhill. *Yay!* That was fun!

The girls and Mother climbed the hill again, and—*whee!*—down they flew. Once again, before reaching the bottom, the girls tumbled off the sled on purpose.

Mother ran beside the sled. Amelie was glad she was there. The night was dark, and the snow was falling fast and heavy. Even with her headlamp, Amelie could barely see.

Suddenly, Amelie realized something was wrong. She reached up and touched her forehead—her headlamp was gone! She



Story Tips

- Show Austria on a map. Then, show Braunau, a town near the German border in the north, where Bogenhofen is located.
- Watch a YouTube video of Amelie at: bit.ly/Amelie-EUD.
- Tell the children that God may not always answer in the way they expect—but He always answers in the way they need.

had no idea when it had fallen off. She had been having so much fun that she hadn't even noticed.

"Mother!" she cried. "My light is gone!"

But Mother wasn't worried. She said they could look for it in the morning.

"It's OK," she said. "Let's go back home. It's getting late."

Still, the girls wanted to look for the missing light. They revisited every place where they had fallen off the sled. No light.

"Mother," Amelie said. "We have to pray."

Mother thought that was a fine idea. So, she and the two girls stood under the falling snowflakes while Amelie prayed.

"Dear God, please help us find the light," she said.

Then they opened their eyes and immediately saw something.

"Mother," Tamia said, "There's something dark lying in the snow."

At first, no one recognized what it was. Was it the headlamp or something else?

They looked closer and saw something even more important than the light. Lying in the snow was a set of keys, including the house key Mother had used to lock the door when they went out to play.

Mother hadn't even realized she'd lost her keys. Amelie probably had lost her headlamp from falling in the snow on purpose, but Mother hadn't been falling at all. How the keys had slipped away was a mystery. But Amelie knew one thing: Father would come home very late that night, and without the house key, they would have

been stuck outside in the cold snow for a very long time. If she had waited even a little longer to pray, the key might have been buried beneath the thick snow, and they wouldn't have found it.

God had answered her prayer—just not in the way she expected. God had responded in the way they needed.

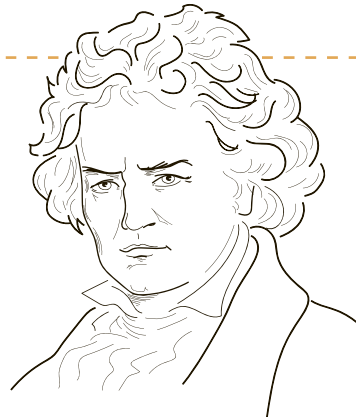
"I prayed for a light, but God answered with keys," she said. 🌐

Thank you for your Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, which will help children in Europe learn about the God who answers prayer. Mother teaches children about the importance of prayer at Bogenhofen, a Seventh-day Adventist school that received part of a previous offering. This quarter's offering will help even more children in the Inter-European Division learn about God. Thank you for planning a generous offering.



AMAZING COUNTRY

Austria is called the birthplace of classical music and was home to Beethoven (pictured), Haydn, Mozart, and Schubert.



BigStockPhoto.com



ROMANIA | September 12

Luca

A Place to Belong

Some little children like to ride in big cars. Some little children like to visit big cities.

But 5-year-old Luca wasn't impressed by big cars or big cities. His mother wanted to take him in a big car to Romania's capital city, Bucharest. But it was a Monday morning, and he only wanted to go to his kindergarten.

Luca loves his Seventh-day Adventist kindergarten.

It wasn't always that way.

Mother first sent him to a public kindergarten when he was two years old. He didn't like it at all. Luca was still wearing diapers because he wasn't potty-trained. He still drank from a baby bottle because he hadn't learned to use a cup. He wasn't able to speak yet—he could only say, “Mm, mmm, mmm.”

Luca had bad days at the public kindergarten. Some teachers weren't nice to him because they didn't want to change his diapers. Others didn't want to refill his baby bottle. And some didn't understand what he meant when he said, “Mm, mmm, mmm.”

Mother was heartbroken when she found out about the unkind treatment. She went to the kindergarten principal and asked that the

teachers be nicer to Luca. But the principal didn't believe her and refused to do anything.

So, Mother looked for a new kindergarten. She visited many, but no one would accept her little boy. They said Luca had a learning challenge, and they didn't have time to help him.

Mother grew desperate. She needed to work to earn money to feed Luca and herself, but she couldn't work if she had to stay home with Luca all day.

Then, she found a Seventh-day Adventist kindergarten online. She went to meet the principal and pleaded for help. With tears streaming down her cheeks, she said, “Please accept my child into your kindergarten. I beg you from the bottom of my heart to help me.”

She explained that Luca did indeed have some learning challenges.

The principal saw Mother's tears and heard the sincerity in her voice.

“Okay,” the principal said. “Let's try. This will be our first child with this kind of learning challenge. We haven't taught any like him before, but we can try. We'll make an effort.”



Mother, her cheeks wet with tears, smiled with relief. She pointed to a young woman standing beside her.

“My niece is here to help me enroll Luca in the school,” she explained.

Mother had never gone to school and couldn’t read or write. But her 20-year-old niece could, and she helped Mother complete the paperwork to enroll Luca in kindergarten.

A month later, on a bright September morning, Luca arrived at the Adventist kindergarten. He was thrilled to see the other children and to play with them.

Mother came to take him home at lunchtime. “This is enough for one day,” she said. “I’ll bring you back tomorrow morning.”

But Luca didn’t want to go home. He wanted to stay and play more. Mother had to persuade him to leave. That had never happened before. He had always been ready to go anywhere with her.

The next day, Luca stayed until 4 o’clock in the afternoon. His teacher said he was adjusting well. Mother was so happy!

As the weeks and months passed, Luca made big improvements. He stopped wearing diapers and learned to use the bathroom by himself. He stopped using the baby bottle and drank from a cup. He stopped saying, “Mm, mmm, mmm” and learned to speak. He even began to read and write. Mother was overjoyed. Luca was learning to do things that even she couldn’t do!

Luca was happy, too. He loved kindergarten so much that he asked Mother

Story Tips

- Show Romania on a map.
- Note that Luca’s mother’s name is Mirela, and the kindergarten principal’s name is Raluca. They can be seen with Luca in the photo on the opposite page. Luca’s mother has blonde hair.
- Watch a short YouTube video of Luca reciting the Lord’s Prayer: bit.ly/Luca-EUD.

to take him on Sabbaths and Sundays when it was closed. He couldn’t understand why Mother wanted to take him in a big car to the big city of Bucharest on a Monday morning. The trip lasted three and a half hours. He would have much rather spent the time at the kindergarten, playing with friends, learning English, taking piano lessons, and hearing stories about Jesus.

Mother explained that they needed to come to Bucharest to talk about the wonderful kindergarten that had changed his life. Then Luca understood. He didn’t mind the long trip or missing a day of school. He loved his kindergarten, and he wanted the whole world to know. 🌐

Part of this quarter’s Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, will help two other schools teach more children and their families about Jesus.



MISSION RECORD

Seventh-day Adventist doctrines were first preached in Romania by M. B. Czechowski, a former Polish Catholic priest who had learned of the seventh-day Sabbath and Christ’s imminent return while in America.

Returning to Europe in 1864, he preached these doctrines in Italy and Switzerland. In the winter of 1868-1869, he came to Romania and preached in Pitesti. About 12 people accepted his message.



BigStockPhoto.com



ROMANIA | September 19

David

Tasty Eggs and New Clothes

The three-year-old children were chatting excitedly in their kindergarten in Romania. The coming weekend would bring a big holiday, and their little minds were filled with thoughts of chocolate eggs and new clothes.

Can you guess which holiday they would celebrate?

"The Easter bunny is going to bring us presents!" a boy squealed.

"I can't wait!" said a girl.

In Romania, many fathers and mothers give their children chocolate eggs and new clothes for Easter. The eggs are for eating, and the clothes are for wearing to church on Easter Sunday. The parents say the gifts are from the Easter bunny.

Teacher Ramona overheard the children's chatter and thought she had better set the record straight.

"You know," she said gently, "there is no Easter bunny."

The chatter stopped, and the children looked at her in surprise.

"Then why are we celebrating Easter?" little David asked.

It was a good question, and Teacher Ramona had a good answer. But she wanted to make sure that David understood it.

"I'll call your mother and invite you both to church on Sabbath," she said. "Then you'll learn why people celebrate Easter."

A short time later, Teacher Ramona called David's mother and invited her and David to church on Sabbath.

"Please come," she said. "We're doing something related to Easter."

Then, Teacher Ramona called the mothers of the 25 other children in her kindergarten class and invited them as well. She wanted all the children and their parents to understand the true meaning of Easter.

After that, Teacher Ramona called the church pastor.

"Do you mind if I change the children's lesson next Sabbath?" she said. "I want to talk about the real meaning of Easter."

The pastor didn't mind at all.

On Sabbath morning, little David arrived at the Seventh-day Adventist church with his mother. His grandmother came too, along with about half of his kindergarten class.



Teacher Ramona was pleased. It was going to be a nice Sabbath.

David brought a small gift for Teacher Ramona. It wasn't a chocolate egg, and it wasn't new clothes. He held up a bouquet of five orange roses.

"Teacher, these are for you," he said.

Teacher Ramona was pleased.

"Thank you," she said with a big smile.

She led him and the other kindergarten children to the room where the little ones gathered for Sabbath School. The room looked very big to David, and he was nervous about letting go of his mother's hand.

"It's OK," Teacher Ramona said. "Your friends from kindergarten are here, and we're going to play together. Your mother will be upstairs with the adults, and we can call her if you need her. Everything will be fine."

David relaxed and let go of Mother's hand. He looked around the room and saw a shallow sandbox. Three crosses stood in the sand. There was also a stone tomb and a group of small plastic people.

A few minutes later, David and the other children learned the real story of Easter.

"Many children think about the Easter bunny when they think of Easter," Teacher Ramona said. "But the Easter bunny is make-believe. Easter actually is about a true story that happened to a real person—Jesus Christ."

Using the items in the sandbox, Teacher Ramona told the story of how Jesus died on the cross on Friday afternoon. Then, after lying in the stone tomb on Sabbath, He rose from the dead on Sunday morning. Today, He is preparing a place for all the little boys and girls who believe in Him, and He will come soon to take them home.

David listened attentively.

Story Tips

- Show Romania on a map. Then, point to Ploiești, where the Seventh-day Adventist school is located.
- Pronounce Ploiești as play-ESH-tee.
- Note that the photo is a stock image depicting a Romanian boy like David.
- Watch a YouTube video of Teacher Ramona at: bit.ly/Ramona-EUD.

Later, he joined his mother and grandmother upstairs in the sanctuary to hear the pastor's sermon. Afterward, his mother gave Teacher Ramona a tight hug.

"I want to come here again," she said.

And she did.

Today, she and David attend church whenever Teacher Ramona teaches the little ones in Sabbath School. He is very happy to come to church with his mother. His mother is very happy to come to church with David. Together, they are learning to love Jesus more and more. They understand now that Easter isn't about the Easter bunny, chocolate eggs, and new clothes. Easter is a reminder that Jesus rose from the tomb and will come soon for all His children. 🌐

Part of this quarter's Thirteenth Sabbath Offering—also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering—will help two schools, such as the one where Teacher Ramona works, to expand so that even more children can learn about Jesus. Thank you for your generous offering.

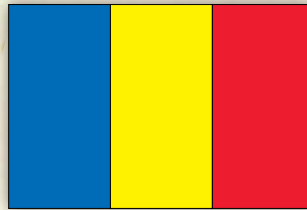


AMAZING COUNTRY

Romania is one of the largest plum producers in the world.



BigStockPhoto.com



13th SABBATH | September 26

Ana, Great-Grandmother Chirca, and Simona

Very Pleased Grandmother

This is a story about a great-grandmother and her two great-granddaughters in Romania.

When Great-grandmother Chirca was a little girl, she learned about Jesus from some kind Seventh-day Adventist neighbors. But she lived in a very strict country that didn't believe in Jesus. Romania was a communist country, and no one was allowed to believe in Him. Her parents forbade her from learning about Jesus and told her she couldn't spend time with the kind Adventist neighbors.

How the little girl wished that she could learn more about Jesus. But it seemed impossible, so she went on with her life. After some time, she got married and had children. Then, her children got married and had children, and she became a grandmother. Then, her children's children got married and had children, and she became the great-grandmother of two little girls—Ana and Simona.

During those many years, life changed in Romania. The communist government ended, and the new government allowed people to believe in Jesus.

Great-grandmother Chirca loved her great-granddaughters Ana and Simona very much. She wanted the very best for them, so, she began to think really hard when the girls had trouble with unkind children in public kindergarten.

Then she learned about a Seventh-day Adventist kindergarten. She remembered learning about Jesus from kind Seventh-day Adventist neighbors when she was a little girl—just like her great-granddaughters. She just knew that Ana and Simona had to go to the Adventist kindergarten.

Great-grandmother Chirca went to the kindergarten and asked the teachers whether the girls could attend. She learned that the kindergarten was already full and didn't have space for two more children. But when the teachers heard that Great-grandmother Chirca was raising the girls on her own, they decided to find room somehow. Eventually, space was found, and Ana and Simona started attending.

Immediately, Ana and Simona loved the kindergarten. When they returned home after the first day, they hugged Great-



grandmother Chirca tightly and declared, “We like this kindergarten so much that we will never go to another one!”

The girls loved their teachers. They loved learning about Jesus and singing about Him. Everything they learned, they shared with Great-grandmother Chirca. They even told her that they had to thank God for every meal.

Great-grandmother Chirca was very pleased.

“It’s good that you have learned to pray before eating,” she said. “God will make you strong when you pray.”

She was so pleased that she began to attend the Seventh-day Adventist church beside the kindergarten on Sabbaths. There, she learned more about Jesus—the same Jesus she had first heard about as a little girl. Even though she was no longer little—even though she was already 84 years old—she gave her heart to Jesus and was baptized.

Great-grandmother Chirca was

Story Tips

- Show Romania on a map. Then show the town of Peretu, where a Seventh-day Adventist school will receive part of this quarter’s Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering.
- Note that the Peretu school opened with only one student in 2016.

so happy! She told other great-grandmothers, grandmothers, and mothers about the kindergarten.

“This kindergarten has changed my life and the lives of my great-granddaughters,” she said.

Soon those great-grandmothers, grandmothers, and mothers began asking



AMAZING COUNTRY

Most people wear modern clothing now. However, traditional garb can still be seen at festivals, worn by folk musicians and dancers. Women’s costumes are often heavily embroidered in largely geometric patterns. The embroidery is said to give a glimpse into the region it comes from through the colors and symbols used.



whether they could send their children to the kindergarten. The teachers made the kindergarten bigger so more children could attend. Now, 55 children attend the kindergarten, including only six from Adventist homes. 🌐

Children across Romania are learning about Jesus at Seventh-day Adventist kindergartens and schools. Part of this quarter's Thirteenth Sabbath Offering—also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering—will help two other schools expand so they can teach even more children about Jesus. Thank you for your generous offering.

Other important projects in the Inter-European Division that will benefit from the offering include a kindergarten in Sofia, Bulgaria; a youth camp, church camp, and

Before 13th Sabbath

- Remind everyone that our mission offerings are gifts to spread God's Word around the world, and that one-fourth of our Thirteenth Sabbath Offering, also known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering, will help five projects in the Inter-European Division. The projects are listed on page three and on the back cover.
- The narrator doesn't need to memorize the story, but he or she should be familiar enough with the material to not have to read it. Alternatively, children and adults can act out the story.
- Before or after the story, use a map to show the places in the Inter-European Division—Belgium, Bulgaria, Italy, and Romania—that will receive the offering.

training center in Belgium; and a dormitory at the Italian Adventist University Villa Aurora in Florence, Italy.

Next Quarter's Mission Projects

The Trans-European Division will be featured next quarter, and the special projects will include:

- Centers of influence at all Adventist schools, British Union Conference
- New church, Zagreb, Croatia
- Family mission center, Vantaa, Finland
- First Adventist school, Poland

Color The Flag

AUSTRIA

DIRECTIONS:

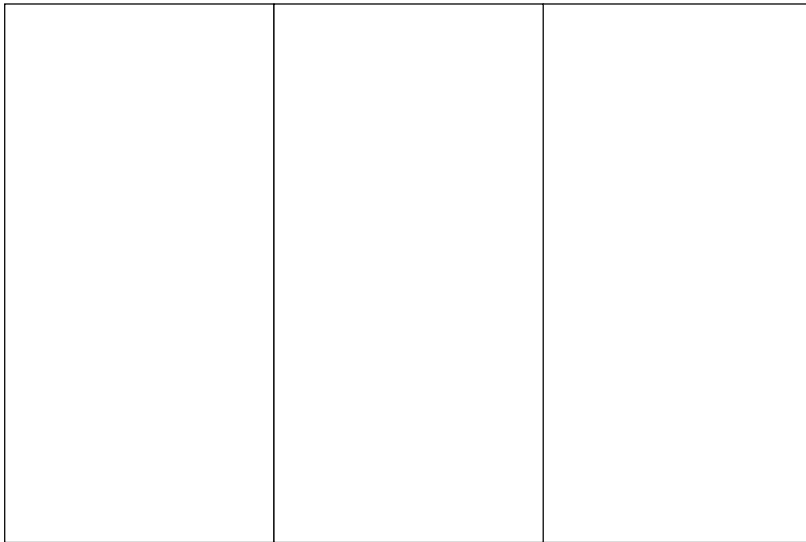
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BULGARIA

DIRECTIONS:

Leave the top white. Color the middle green. Color the bottom red.

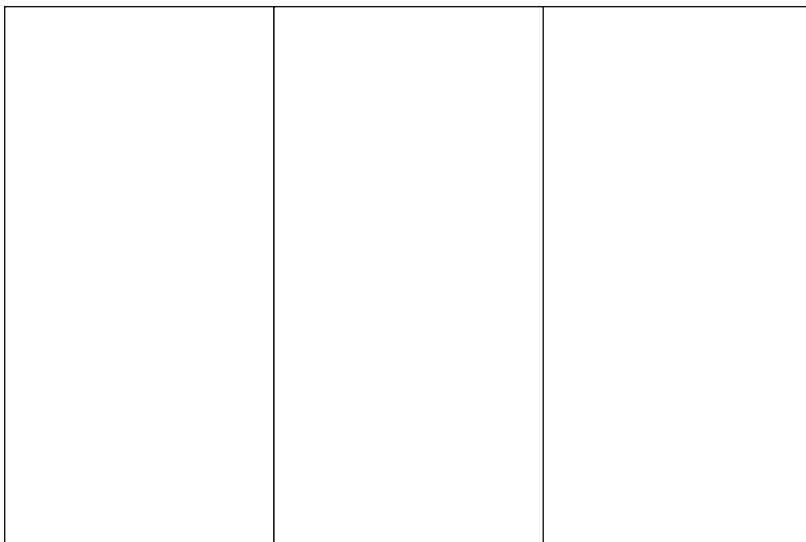
Color The Flag



ITALY

DIRECTIONS:

Color the left green. Leave the middle white. Color the right red.



ROMANIA

DIRECTIONS:

Color the left dark blue. Color the middle yellow. Color the right red.

Play a Game

BULGARIA

DAMA (TURKISH DRAUGHTS/CHECKERS)

Bulgarian children play a version of checkers or draughts that may differ slightly from the checkers you know.

INSTRUCTIONS:

The board is 8x8 squares, all colored the same. Each player has sixteen markers (men) lined up in two rows on each side of the board, leaving the back row empty.

White moves first, and players can move their pieces forward or sideways one square (not diagonally or backwards). They can capture their opponent's pieces by jumping over them into an empty square. When they reach the empty row at the other side of the board, their piece becomes a "king," which can now move any number of squares in a straight line forward,

backward, or sideways to jump over an opponent's pieces.

A player wins when they have captured all their opponent's pieces or the opponent is blocked in and can't make any more moves.

To make a simple Dama board, draw squares on a piece of paper in an 8x8 inch grid. Cut out 32 pieces of paper small enough to fit into the squares. Leave 16 white and color the other 16 another color. Draw an X on the back side of each square – when the piece reaches the other side and becomes a "king," turn it over so the X shows.

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Turkish_draughts

Let's Cook!

SPAIN

TAPAS (SPANISH OMELET)

INGREDIENTS:

1.3 lb (600 g) cooked potatoes (rinsed, peeled, quartered, thinly sliced)
2 ¼ cup (560 ml) olive oil

1 small onion, thinly sliced
4 medium to large eggs
1 ½ tsp salt

INSTRUCTIONS:

Fry potatoes in 2 cups of oil for 5 minutes. Add onions for another 5 minutes. Drain oil. Whisk the eggs and salt in bowl, then mix in potatoes and onions. Fry in ¼ cup oil.

<https://www.happyfoodstube.com/spanish-omelette-tortilla-espanola/>

Sing a Song

ITALY

TUTTE LE COSE LUMINOSE E BELLE (ALL THINGS BRIGHT AND BEAUTIFUL)

Many of the songs we sing in church and Sabbath School have been translated into many languages. Sometimes, they are translated almost word for word, and sometimes the words are a little different, while still expressing the same idea.

Look at the song below. We know it in English as “All Things Bright and Beautiful,” written in 1848 by an Irish woman named Cecil Frances Alexander. The original words are on the left. The Italian translation is in the middle. And on the right is the Italian translated back into English. Aren’t all three versions beautiful?

ENGLISH

All things bright and beautiful,
all creatures great and small,
all things wise and wonderful,
the Lord God made them all.

Each little flow’r that opens,
each little bird that sings,
He made their glowing colors,
He made their tiny wings.

The purple-headed mountain,
the river running by,
the sunset and the morning
that brightens up the sky.

The cold wind in the winter,
the pleasant summer sun,
the ripe fruits in the garden:
He made them every one.

He gave us eyes to see them,
and lips that we might tell
how great is God Almighty,
Who has made all things well.

ITALIAN

Tutto ciò che sulla terra c’è
d quello che brilla in ciel, ogni
cosa che abbiamo al mondo la
dobbiamo a Te.

I fiori che noi vediamo,
uccelli che cantano in ciel, essi
splendono essi brillano della
Tua bontà Signor.

Le cime delle montagne,
i fiumi che scorrono al mar,
il tramonto e l’alba la luna e
il sol splendon tutti del Tua
amor.

Il vento freddo d’inverno
l’estate che scalda col sol, ed
i frutti che nel giardino son
parlan tutti di Te Signor.

La vita di noi bambini
più bella più dolce che c’è, la
dobbiamo a te o Signore e Ti
ringraziamo di cuor.

TRANSLATION

All that is on earth and
all that shines in the sky,
Everything we have in the
world we owe to You.

The flowers we see,
birds that sing in the sky,
they shine, they shine with
Your goodness, Lord.

The mountain tops, the
rivers that flow to the sea,
the sunset and the sunrise
the moon and the sun all
shine with Your love.

The cold wind of winter,
the summer that warms
with the sun, and the fruits
that are in the garden all
speak of You, Lord.

The life of us children,
the most beautiful and
sweetest there is, we owe
it to You, O Lord, and we
thank You from our hearts.

Leader's Resources

Be sure to download your free *Mission Spotlight* video featuring video reports from around the Inter-European Division and beyond. Download or stream from the Adventist Mission website at bit.ly/missionspotlight.

Online Information

Following are sources of information that may be helpful in preparing for the mission segment of Sabbath School. For more information on the cultures and history of the countries featured in this quarterly, visit:

Websites

Austria: government website	bit.ly/AustriaGovt
Britannica	bit.ly/BritAustria
Austria Info	www.austria.info/en-us
Bulgaria: government website	www.gov.bg/en
Lonely Planet	bit.ly/LPBulgaria
Visit My Bulgaria	visitmybulgaria.com
Italy: government website	www.governo.it/en
Italia.it	www.italia.it/en
Fodor's	bit.ly/FodorsItaly
Romania: government website	www.gov.ro/en
Tourism Romania	www.romaniatourism.com
Wikitravel	wikitravel.org/en/Romania
Spain: government website	bit.ly/EspGovt
España	www.spain.info/en
National Geographic	on.natgeo.com/4jPmQXi

Seventh-day Adventist

Inter-European Division	eud.adventist.org
Austrian Union of Churches Conference	www.adventisten.at
Bulgarian Union of Churches Conference	www.adventist.bg
Italian Union of Churches Conference	www.chiesaavventista.it
Romanian Union Conference	www.adventist.ro
Spanish Union of Churches Conference	www.adventista.es

The Thirteenth Sabbath Offering is known as the Quarterly Mission Project Offering in some world regions, which may use an offering goal device to help focus attention on world missions and increase weekly mission giving: Determine a goal for your class's weekly mission offering. Multiply it by 14, allowing a double goal for the Thirteenth Sabbath Offering. Remind the listeners that their regular weekly mission offerings help the missionary work of the world church and that one-quarter of the offering will go directly to the projects in the Inter-European Division. Report on mission giving during the quarter. Encourage the listeners to double or triple their normal mission giving on the upcoming Thirteenth Sabbath. Count the offering and record the amount given at the end of Sabbath School.

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children's mission

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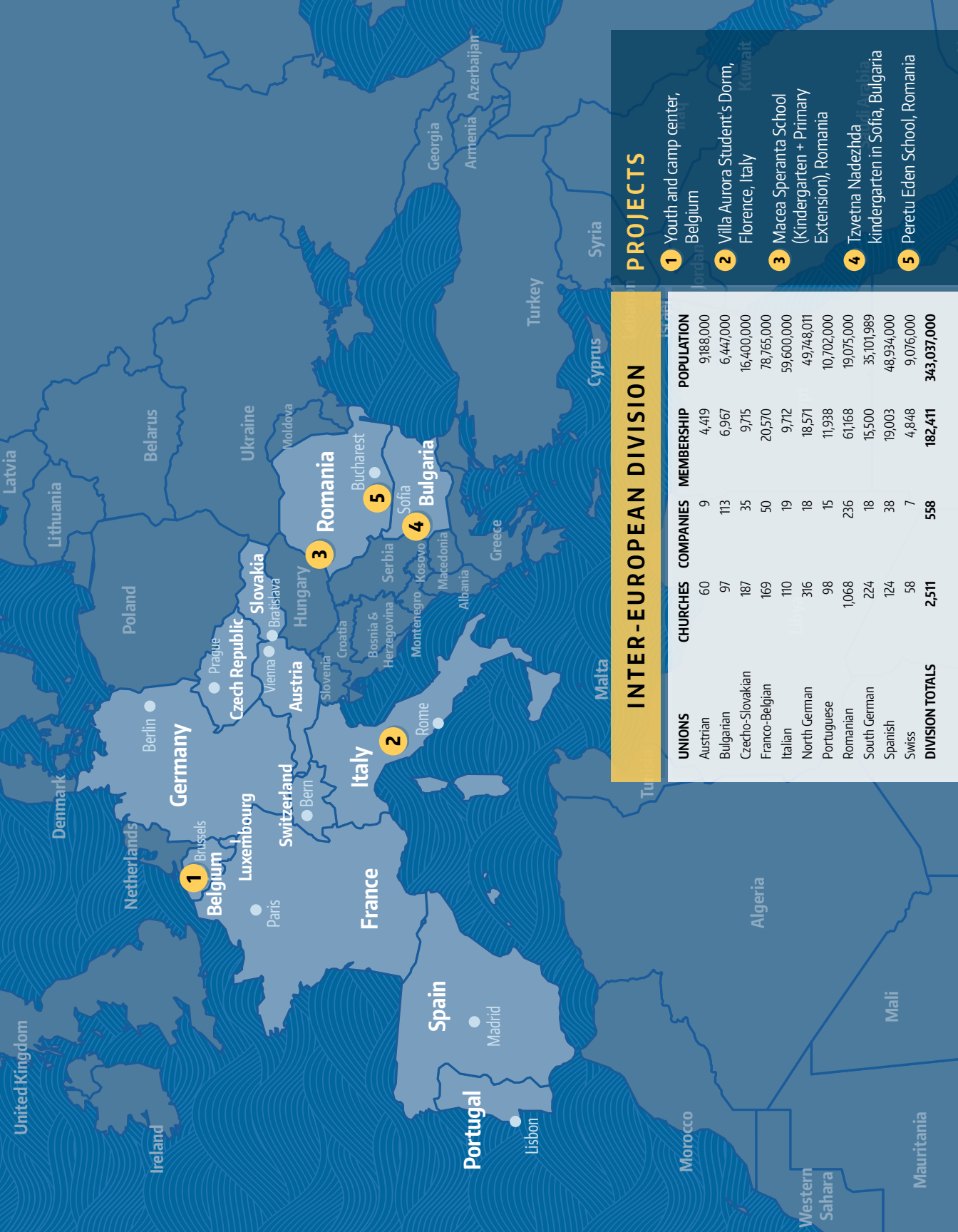
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INTER-EUROPEAN DIVISION

PROJECTS

UNIONS	CHURCHES	COMPANIES	MEMBERSHIP	POPULATION
Austrian	60	9	4,419	9,188,000
Bulgarian	97	113	6,967	6,447,000
Czecho-Slovakian	187	35	9,715	16,400,000
Franco-Belgian	169	50	20,570	78,765,000
Italian	110	19	9,712	59,600,000
North German	316	18	18,571	49,748,011
Portuguese	98	15	11,938	10,702,000
Romanian	1068	236	61,168	19,075,000
South German	224	18	15,500	35,101,989
Spanish	124	38	19,003	48,934,000
Swiss	58	7	4,848	9,076,000
DIVISION TOTALS	2,511	558	182,411	343,037,000

- 1 Youth and camp center, Belgium
- 2 Villa Aurora Student's Dorm, Florence, Italy
- 3 Macea Speranta School (Kindergarten + Primary Extension), Romania
- 4 Tzvetna Nadezhda kindergarten in Sofia, Bulgaria
- 5 Peretu Eden School, Romania